

Yubico Support

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Troubleshooting issues with GPG

Compatible devices

Compatible

YubiKey 5 FIPS Series

Incompatible

YubiKey Bio Series

Incompatible

Security Key Series

Compatible

YubiKey 5 Series

Compatible

YubiKey FIPS (4 Series)

Incompatible

YubiHSM Series

Mixed Compatibility

Legacy Devices

Compatible

YubiKey 4 Series

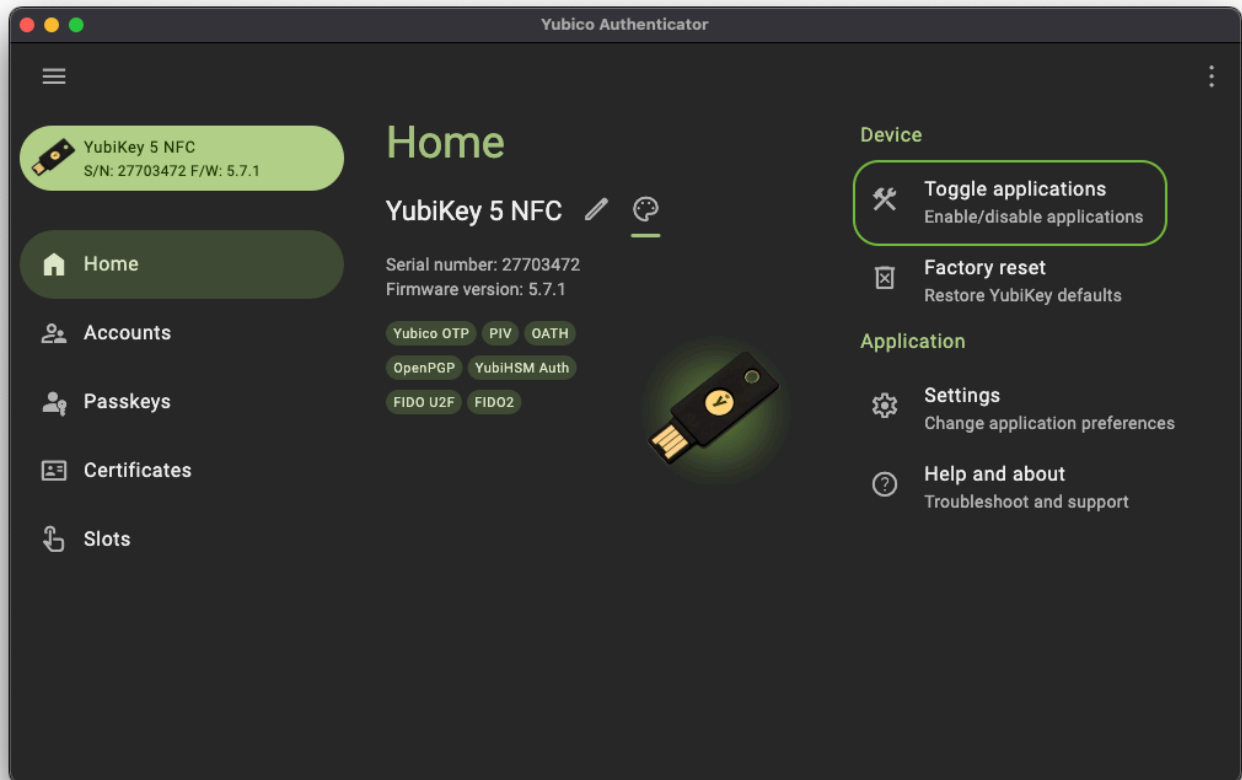
This article covers some of the issues you may experience when using GnuPG (GPG) with your YubiKey, and possible solutions.

gpg --card-status

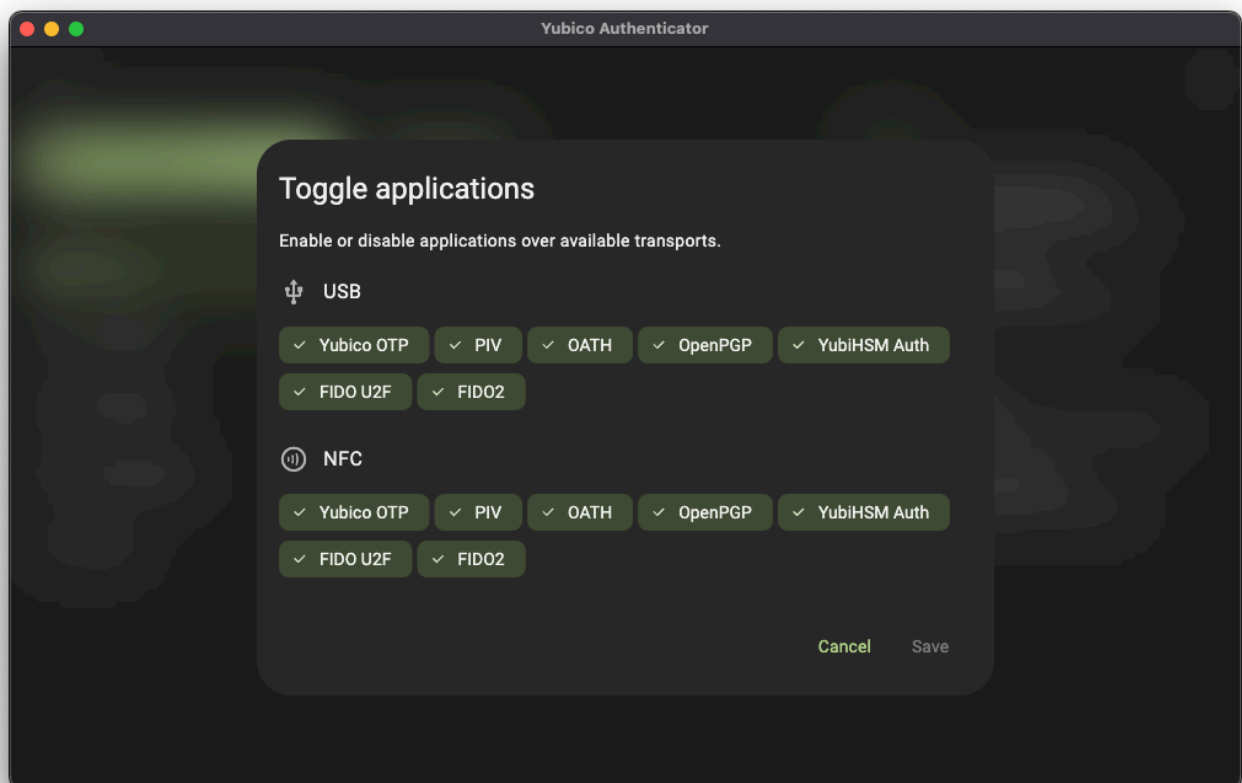
If `gpg --card-status` fails to detect the YubiKey, try following the steps below.

1. Double-check that your device includes support for OpenPGP (see the **Compatible devices** section above).

2. From the Home page of [Yubico Authenticator](https://www.yubico.com/products/yubico-authenticator/) (<https://www.yubico.com/products/yubico-authenticator/>), click **Toggle applications**. If you don't see this option, expand the kebab menu at the top right corner.



3. If OpenPGP isn't selected in the applications list, select it and then click **Save**.



4. Specify the smart card reader GPG uses by adding the line **reader-port Yubico Yubi** to the file `scdaemon.conf`. Create this file if it does not exist. After making this change, reboot your computer to ensure it takes affect.
- On Windows, this file's path should be `%APPDATA%\gnupg\scdaemon.conf`

- On macOS and Linux, it is `~/.gnupg/scdaemon.conf`
 - On macOS and Linux, you may need to add `reader-port Yubico Yubikey` (with a lowercase K) instead of what is above if you are using a YubiKey 4 Series or NEO
5. Test with a fresh set of GPG configuration files. To do this, rename your GPG folder (add `.old` to the end, etc.) so that GPG can no longer "see" it, reboot your system, and re-run `gpg --card-status`. This will create a new folder, with fresh default files.
- On Windows, the path to your GPG folder should be `%APPDATA%\gnupg`
 - On macOS and Linux, it should instead be `~/.gnupg`
 - If this doesn't help, you can revert to your old configuration by renaming/deleting the new folder, and then renaming the original back to its original name (remove `.old`, etc. from the end of the name).

If `gpg --card-status` detects the YubiKey, but throws the error `Operation not supported by device`, try configuring GPG's `scdaemon` to open the YubiKey in shared mode (instead of exclusive) by adding **shared-access** to your `scdaemon.conf` file, and rebooting your computer. See item 4 above for more details on where to find/create this file on your system.

In the case of a conflict on the CCID communication channel you might also need to disable the `scdaemon`'s integrated support for Smart Card Readers (disable-ccid), for more information refer to [Resolving GPG's CCID conflicts \(/s/article/Resolving-GPGs-CCID-conflicts\)](/s/article/Resolving-GPGs-CCID-conflicts).

Importing PGP key to the YubiKey fails

If you run `keytocard` under the `gpg --card-edit` feature and it fails, this usually indicates you are using a large key (4096bit) and an older version of GPG. For large keys you need to use GPG v2.0 or newer which you can verify by running `gpg --version`. On some systems, both GPG v1.x and GPG v2.x exist simultaneously and you need to access GPG v2 by running `gpg2` instead of `gpg`.

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